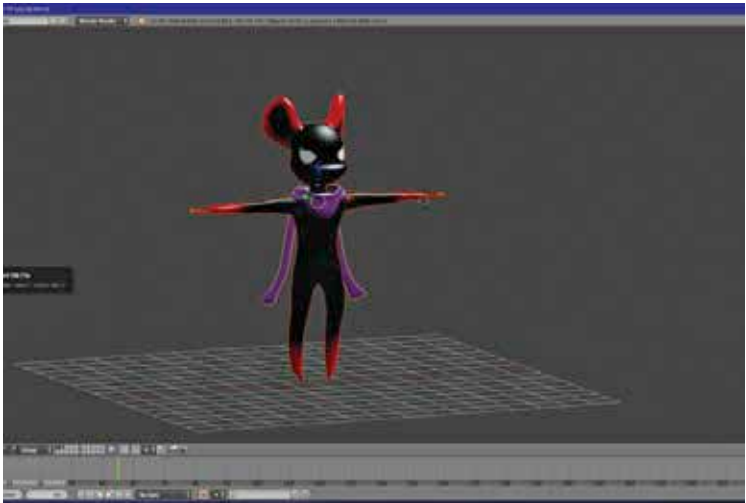


going about building and attaching a bone structure to a mesh. Unlike the normal method of making bone structures with a parent-child relationship, movement of the bones of the mesh is determined by a “focal bone” or a “target bone”. In essence, you position the end of the chain of the bones, and the IK solver determines the position of the other bones about the “target bone” thereby making the animation look smoother and uniform, not clunky or as a sum of parts.

Step 1: Start Blender and open a new file by clicking on the File option in the top left corner of the Blender window and import a base model, a biped in this case, on which we’ll be working on.

Step 2: Line up the model with the origin plane, where the x, y and z-axes intersect in the Blender grid. Select all the parts of the model, enter the orthographic mode and then switch to front ortho view. This provides the flattest view of the character from straight on making it easier to see



Setting up the focal bone, around which the entire rig will be built.

the feet. From here on, line up the feet such that the sole is on top of the red line. This ensures that wherever the character is rendered, it stays above the ground level else there’ll be a glitchy animation with changing screen characteristics.

Step 3: Final step before the actual rigging starts is to ensure that the origin of the model is properly centred inside the model. To do this, press